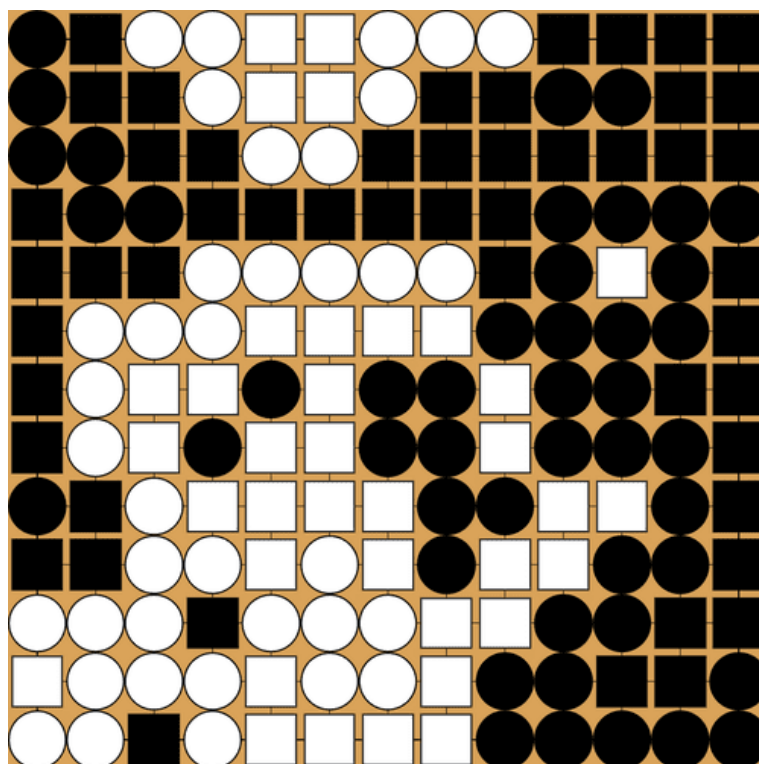


Mander

2026, Luis Bolaños Mures, <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3662629>



Mander game won by Black

Mander, Redmander and Perimander are territory games for two players: Black and White. They are played on the intersections (points) of an initially empty, odd-sized square grid (board). Mander uses black and white pieces in two shapes: circles and squares. Redmander and Perimander use black, white and red circles (stones) but no squares. Red pieces are neutral. Some definitions:

- A **group** is a piece along with all pieces one can reach from it through a series of steps onto orthogonally adjacent, identical pieces.
- A **clump** is a piece along with all pieces one can reach from it through a series of steps onto orthogonally adjacent, non-neutral pieces of its same shape.
- A clump or group is **bounded** if there are no empty points orthogonally adjacent to it.
- To **claim** a clump or group is to replace all pieces in it with friendly pieces of the same shape.

Black plays first, then turns alternate. To ensure fairness, White will have the option, on their first turn only, to swap sides with Black instead of making a regular move. When the board is full, whoever has the higher score wins. Remaining rules:

- Mander: On your turn, place a circle or square of your color on an empty point, then let every newly bounded clump be claimed by the player who owns the majority of pieces in it. Tied clumps of this kind are claimed by your opponent. Your score is the number of on-board friendly pieces of your color of the shape of which you have less. If scores are tied, each player scores their other shape instead.
- Redmander: On your turn, place a stone of your color and (if possible) a red stone on empty points, in that order. Do not form 2×2 blocks with red stones. After each placement, let every newly bounded clump be claimed by the player who owns the majority of stones in it. Tied clumps of this kind are claimed by your opponent. Note red stones are not part of clumps. Your score is the number of stones of your color on the board. If there is a tie, whoever made the last placement loses. For a fun variant, select the location of red stone placements at random.
- Perimander: On your turn, place a stone of your color and a red stone on empty points. If there is only one empty point, place only a stone of your color. After each placement, let every bounded red group be claimed by the player who owns the majority of stones orthogonally adjacent to it. Tied groups of this kind are claimed by your opponent. Your score is the number of stones of your color on the board. For a fun variant, select the location of red stone placements at random.

These are such plain games that I wouldn't be surprised if they were broken, but as of now they seem pleasant enough. You can try them out on [my GitHub](#) (human play only for now). Mirror play is easily defeated in Redmander and Perimander by playing on a point and its mirror on the same turn, and the combination of odd-sized boards, pie rule and last-mover-loses-ties invalidates it in Mander, as it would do in many other games.

[BGG description]